Conférence Épiscopale Nationale du Cameroun
National Episcopal Conference of Cameroon

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Le Président

OFFICIAL STATEMENT FROM THE NATIONAL EPISCOPAL CONFERENCE OF CAMEROON (NECC) ON POPE LEON XIV'S APOSTOLIC JOURNEY TO CAMEROON UNDER THE GENERAL THEME: "MAY THEY ALL BE ONE" (John 17: 21)

To the entire People of God,

Dear Faithful of Christ,

I am writing this letter on behalf of the Bishops of the National Episcopal Conference of Cameroon (NECC) to officially announce that the Holy Father, Pope Leo XIV, will undertake a trip to Africa that will lead him successively to **Algeria**, **Cameroon**, **Angola**, and **Equatorial Guinea** from **April 13 to 23, 2026.**

As far as Cameroon is concerned, the Holy Father's program is as follows:

WEDNESDAY 15 APRIL 2026: YAOUNDÉ

15:20	Arrival at Yaoundé-Nsimalen International Airport **WELCOME CEREMONY**	
16:20	**COURTESY VISIT to The President of the Republic** at the Presidential Palace	
17:05	**MEETING with the Authorities, Civil Society and the Diplomatic Corps** at the Congress Center	*Address of the Holy Father*
17:45	**VISIT to the Ngul Zamba Orphanage**	*Greeting of the Holy Father*
18:25	**PRIVATE MEETING** with the Bishops of Cameroon at the headquarters of the Episcopal Conference	

THURSDAY 16 APRIL 2026: YAOUNDÉ – BAMENDA – YAOUNDÉ

10:05	Departure from Yaoundé-Nsimalen International Airport for Bamenda	
11:00	Arrival at Bamenda Airport	
11:30	**MEETING for peace with the Community of Bamenda** in Saint Joseph's Cathedral	*Address of the Holy Father*
15:15	**HOLY MASS** at Bamenda International Airport	*Homily of the Holy Father*
17:25	Departure from Bamenda Airport for Yaoundé	
18:20	Arrival at Yaoundé-Nsimalen International Airport	

FRIDAY 17 APRIL 2026: YAOUNDÉ – DOUALA – YAOUNDÉ

09:00	Departure from Yaoundé-Nsimalen Airport for Douala	
09:55	Arrival at Douala International Airport	
11:00	**HOLY MASS** at "Japoma Stadium"	*Homily of the Holy Father*
13:20	**PRIVATE VISIT to *Saint Paul* Catholic Hospital**	
14:10	Departure from Douala Airport for Yaoundé	

15:15 Arrival at Yaoundé-Nsimalen International Airport

17:30 **MEETING With University Students and Professors** at the Catholic University of Central Africa — ***Address of the Holy Father***

SATURDAY 18 APRIL 2026: YAOUNDÉ

09:30 **HOLY MASS** at Yaoundé-Ville Airport — ***Homily of the Holy Father***

12:00 **FAREWELL CEREMONY at Yaoundé-Nsimalen International Airport**

12:30 Departure by airplane from Yaoundé-Nsimalen International Airport for Luanda

With regard to Eucharistic celebrations:

- ✓ In **BAMENDA**, this refers to the Ecclesiastical Province of **BAMENDA.** Theme: **"My peace I leave you, my peace I give you" (John 14: 27);**
- ✓ In **DOUALA**, this refers to the Ecclesiastical Province of **DOUALA.** Theme: **« Donnez-leur vous-mêmes à manger » (Luc 9, 13) ;**
- ✓ In **YAOUNDÉ**, this refers to the Ecclesiastical Provinces of **YAOUNDÉ, BERTOUA,** and **GAROUA**. Theme : **« Justice et paix s'embrassent lorsqu'amour et vérité se rencontrent » (cf. Psaume 84, 11).**

I urge the faithful to participate in large numbers in the various Eucharistic celebrations.

Practical information:

1. Access to the various celebration sites does not require any registration fee or payment to participate;
2. An official national loincloth, polos, etc. will be available in the coming days; please be patient as you await these items;
3. Anyone wishing to obtain information regarding Eucharistic Celebration in any of the cities mentioned should contact the local Metropolitan Archbishop;
4. We encourage you to recite daily the prayer we have proposed for the Pope's Apostolic Journey. We also ask you to use the General Them and the specific themes of the various Ecclesiastical Provinces in your prayers.

Counting on your spirit of hospitality to warmly welcome our Guest, please accept my deepest gratitude and the assurance of my prayers.

May God bless you abundantly.

Done at Yaoundé, March 17, 2026

CONFERENCE NATIONALE DU CAMEROUN
EPISCOPAL CONFERENCE OF CAMEROON
Yaoundé
The President
Tel 222 31 15 92

† Andrew NKEA
Archbishop of Bamenda
President of the NECC